

“This Is a Story About Nerds and Cops”:
PredPol and Algorithmic Policing

It is now possible to predict the future when it comes to crime, such as identifying crime trends, anticipating hotspots in the community, refining resource deployment decisions, and ensuring the greatest protection for citizens in the most efficient manner.

—Colleen McCue, *Data Mining
and Predictive Analysis*¹

After googling the law enforcement software start-up company PredPol (short for “predictive policing”), something strange happened—PredPol advertisements kept reappearing in my Twitter feed. PredPol wasn’t on my radar at this point—I had come across the company while doing preliminary research on the use of predictive analytics in current law enforcement practices. But PredPol forced its way into my consciousness with its incessant stream of advertisements touting that the



company was helping “build safer communities.” The first advertisement I encountered in my feed read: “More Than a HotSpot Tool, we use no personal data to help Law Enforcement agencies to build safer communities.”



The advertisement tried to reassure me that the company was not monitoring my behavior, which was somewhat unsettling given that the ad likely only appeared in my feed because of my Google searches. A few days passed without me thinking much about PredPol or its creepy ads in my Twitter feed. In the meantime, I tweeted at some of my friends who are interested in policing and technology about an essay I was developing on predictive policing. In response to a tweet I posted on data and policing, @newyorkyearzero noted that the unique thing about the statistical analysis police program CompStat was not its methodological innovations, but how it represented police “science” to the public. I replied that the use of crime statistics to legitimize the police and prisons was nothing new; since the late nineteenth century, a data-driven approach to understanding crime has been used to perpetuate institutionalized antiblack violence and legitimize policing. Other activist intellectuals began to chime in on the conversation and share links to articles, and advertisements for PredPol began to pop up in their feeds as well as in the feeds of





bystanders who follow me on Twitter but did not participate in the exchange.

PredPol's data-driven approach to policing, as well as the aggressive marketing tactics deployed by the company to legitimize its methods, makes it an ideal case to examine when trying to understand the algorithmic turn in policing. PredPol draws on many of the tenets of the "police science" paradigm to solve two contemporary crises: the crisis of legitimacy suffered by the police and a broader epistemological crisis that could be called the crisis of uncertainty. In this essay I will critique the widespread use and assessment of PredPol in the ways that it: 1) concedes to the inevitability of crime and creates zones of paranoia, 2) generates false positives that can be used to promote the product, and 3) depoliticizes policing and the construction of crime.



PredPol and Algorithmic Policing

The use of predictive analytics is standard in the commercial sector. The purchases we make at the grocery store are used to determine which coupons will be printed out with our receipt, while our past purchases on Amazon are used to generate a bottomless feed of product recommendations. However, the adaptation of predictive analytics in the realm of law enforcement has been more gradual, though in recent years there has been a substantial

push by the tech industry to develop predictive policing technology. IBM has spent more than \$14 billion on developing predictive analytics software for both commerce and law enforcement sectors. By late 2013, PredPol alone received \$1.3 million in seed funding by Silicon Valley investors.²

The ideological foundation for PredPol and other predictive policing technologies can be traced to George Kelling, a criminologist who is affiliated with the conservative Manhattan Institute. Beginning in the 1980s, he advocated the use of statistical analysis to more effectively distribute law enforcement resources. In the mid-1990s, CompStat was introduced into the New York Police Department (NYPD), which encouraged officers to make decisions about which areas to police based on statistical analysis rather than intuition. Since the 1990s, more than 150 police departments nationwide have adopted policing software and equipment that allows for statistical analysis. According to *SF Weekly*, “Interest in predictive policing spiked nationally in 2009 as the National Institute of Justice, the research and policy branch of the Department of Justice, published a series of white papers and doled out millions in grant money to seven police departments to undertake the task.”³

The Los Angeles Police Department received one of these grants to undertake predictive policing research. At the same time, the University of



California, Los Angeles (UCLA) was conducting research funded by the army, navy, and air force that used algorithms—based on earthquake predictions—to track insurgents and predict casualties in war zones overseas. This software, which was first used in Iraq and later evolved into PredPol, was the brainchild of an anthropology professor, Jeffrey Brantingham; a math professor, Andrea Bertozzi; and a mathematics postdoctoral researcher, George Mohler.



Sean Malinowski, who oversaw the LAPD predictive policing grant, linked the efforts of the LAPD with the predictive policing methods that were being developed at UCLA. Malinowski attended the Egyptian National Police Academy in Cairo, where he studied counterterrorism. Later, the federal-funded research project was turned into a Silicon Valley start-up when Mohler, who became a professor at Santa Clara University, made connections with Ryan Coonerty, Caleb Baskin, and Zach Friend. Mohler noted that “Zach was a media mastermind—he’d worked in the press office of the 2008 Obama campaign. Once PopSci and The New York Times picked up the story, it was off to the races.”⁴ Thus, the developers of PredPol were concerned with not only creating a tool that would make law enforcement more efficient, but also constructing a brand that would pique the interest of the media.





The Crisis of Legitimacy



In the twentieth century, police brutality and violence against people of color has historically been a catalyst for riots, uprisings, and civil unrest in the United States. In the post–civil rights era, the riot most prominently seared into the public imagination is the 1992 Los Angeles riot, which erupted on April 29, 1992, following the acquittal of the four police officers charged with the beating of Rodney King. Though the 1992 riots were the largest the United States has seen since the 1960s, numerous riots sparked by police violence against young black men have occurred in such cities as Cincinnati (2001), Oakland (2009), and, most recently, Ferguson (2014).



In the past several years there has been a shift in public perception of the police. In 2014 the American Civil Liberties Union released a lengthy report on the militarization of the police, based on information it collected after filing more than 255 Freedom of Information Act requests in 2013. Interactions between police and social movements have also shaped the public perception of the police. In 2011 the mass arrests and violent evictions of protesters who participated in the Occupy movement generated public discussion about the militarization of the police and the use of excessive force against peaceful demonstrators. Though



liberals and radicals were initially ambivalent about how these emerging social movements should relate to the police, the discourse has shifted toward a more critical stance toward the police.

In recent years, the police's growing crisis of legitimacy is apparent in the wave of urban and suburban uprisings that have taken place in response to the murder of young black men by police officers, as well as to widespread racial profiling (more recent campaigns have included women, trans, and gender nonconforming people as well). In 2011, at the peak of New York City's stop-and-frisk program, 87 percent of the people stopped and frisked were black or Latinx.⁵ Massive demonstrations against stop-and-frisk took place in New York City in 2012, and in 2013 Bill de Blasio was elected mayor of New York City on a promise to overhaul stop-and-frisk. The riots and protests in Ferguson, sparked by the murder of Mike Brown, and the mass demonstrations ignited by the grand jury decisions not to indict the officers who murdered Mike Brown and Eric Garner mark the pinnacle of the police's crisis of legitimacy. Around the United States and beyond, people are chanting "No justice, no peace, no racist police."



According to the National Institute of Justice, "Research consistently shows that minorities are more likely than whites to view law enforcement

with suspicion and distrust.”⁶ This distrust of police has been widespread among communities of color for a very long time. In the last half decade, the majority of the major urban uprisings and riots that have occurred in the United States were ignited by police violence. Antipolice sentiment also became spectacularly visible when, in the late 1960s, the Black Panther Party (BPP) formed armed patrols to “police the police” in black neighborhoods. The BPP asserted that police brutality was a cornerstone of American racism, and it also popularized use of the derogatory term “pig” to refer to cops.⁷

The legitimacy of the police has always been questioned by those who are most affected by policing, such as the poor black and brown people who are routinely stopped and frisked, harassed, surveilled, and forced to live under the glare of the massive floodlights posted around New York City Housing Authority housing projects under the NYPD’s “Omnipresence” program. However, in recent years this discontent has been generalized as a result of the street protests and riots that have been ignited in response to instances of police violence, as well as to the rapid spread of damning footage of police murders captured on cell phones.

In 2011, Harvard’s John F. Kennedy School of Government and the National Institute of Justice published a paper titled “Police Science: Toward a



New Paradigm,” the ideas of which were developed at the Executive Session on Policing and Public Safety hosted at Harvard University. The paper calls for a “radical reformation of the role of science in policing” that prioritizes evidence-based policies and emphasizes the need for closer collaboration between universities and police departments.⁸ In the opening paragraph, the authors, David Weisburd and Peter Neyroud, assert that “the advancement of science in policing is essential if police are to retain public support and legitimacy.”⁹ Given that critics of the police associate law enforcement with the arbitrary use of force, racial domination, and the discretionary power to make decisions about who will live and who will die, the rebranding of policing in a way that foregrounds statistical impersonality and symbolically removes the agency of individual officers is a clever way to cast police activity as neutral, unbiased, and rational. This glosses over the fact that using crime data gathered by the police to determine where officers should go simply sends police to patrol the poor neighborhoods they have historically patrolled when they were guided by their intuitions and biases.

This “new paradigm” is not merely a reworking of the models and practices used by law enforcement, but a revision of the police’s public image through the deployment of science’s claims to



objectivity. As Zach Friend, the man behind PredPol's media strategy, noted in an interview, "it kind of sounds like fiction, but it's more like science fact."¹⁰ By appealing to "fact" and recasting policing as a neutral science, algorithmic policing attempts to solve the police's crisis of legitimacy.

The Crisis of Uncertainty



Whereas repression has, within cybernetic capitalism, the role of warding off events, prediction is its corollary, insofar as it aims to eliminate all uncertainty connected to all possible futures. That's the gamble of statistics technologies. Whereas the technologies of the Providential State were focused on the forecasting of risks, whether probabilized or not, the technologies of cybernetic capitalism aim to multiply the domains of responsibility/authority.



—Tiqqun, *The Cybernetic Hypothesis*¹¹

Uncertainty is at once a problem of information and an existential problem that shapes how we inhabit the world. If we concede that we exist in a world that is fundamentally inscrutable for individual humans, then we also admit to being vulnerable to any number of risks that are outside our control. The less "in control" we feel, the more we may desire order. This desire for law and order—which is heightened when we are made



aware of our corporeal vulnerability to potential threats that are unknowable to us—can be strategically manipulated by companies that use algorithmic policing practices to prevent crime and terrorism at home and abroad. Catastrophes, war, and crime epidemics may further deepen our collective desire for security.

In the age of “big data,” uncertainty is presented as an information problem that can be overcome with comprehensive data collection, statistical analysis that can identify patterns and relationships, and algorithms that can determine future outcomes by analyzing past outcomes. Predictive policing promises to remove the existential terror of not knowing what is going to happen by using data to deliver accurate knowledge about where and when crime will occur. Data installs itself as a solution to the problem of uncertainty by claiming to achieve total awareness and overcome human analytical limitations. As Mark Andrejevic writes in *Infoglut*, “The promise of automated data processing is to unearth the patterns that are far too complex for any human analyst to detect and to run the simulations that generate emergent patterns that would otherwise defy our predictive power.”¹²

The anonymous French ultraleftist collective Tiqqun links the rise of the crisis of uncertainty to the rise of cybernetics. Tiqqun describes cybernetics—a



discipline founded by Norbert Wiener and others in the 1940s—as an ideology of management, self-organization, rationalization, control, automation, and technical certitude. According to Tiqqun, this ideology took root following World War II. It seeks to resolve “the metaphysical problem of creating order out of disorder” to overcome crisis, instability, and disequilibrium, which Tiqqun asserts is an inherent by-product of capitalist growth.¹³ However, the “metaphysical” problem of uncertainty that is created by crisis enables cybernetic ideology to take root. Drawing on Giorgio Agamben’s *State of Exception*, Tiqqun writes, “The state of emergency, which is proper to all crises, is what allows self-regulation to be relaunched.”¹⁴ Even though, by nearly every metric, “Americans now live in one of the least violent times in the nation’s history,” Americans believe that crime rates are going up.¹⁵ Empirically, there is no basis for the belief that there is an unprecedented crime boom that threatens to unravel society, but affective investments in this worldview expand the domain of surveillance and policing and authorizes what Manuel Abreu calls “algorithmic necropower.”¹⁶ The security state’s calculation of risk through data-mining techniques sanctions the targeting of “threats” for death or disappearance. Though the goal of algorithmic policing is, ostensibly, to reduce crime, if there were no social





threats to manage, these companies would be out of business.

Whether or not we accept Tiqqun's account of how capitalist growth generates a metaphysical crisis that enables the installation of cybernetic governance, it is clear that PredPol appeals to our desire for certitude and knowledge about the future. UCLA professor Brantingham emphasizes, in his promotion of PredPol, that "humans are not nearly as random as we think."¹⁷ Drawing on evolutionary notions of human behavior, Brantingham describes criminals as modern-day urban foragers whose desires and behavioral patterns can be predicted. By reducing human actors to their innate instincts and applying complex mathematical models to track the behavior of these urban "hunter-gathers," Brantingham's predictive policing model attempts to create "order" out of the seeming disorder of human behavior.



Paranoia

But what does PredPol actually do? How does it actually work? PredPol is a software program that uses proprietary algorithms (modeled after equations used to determine earthquake aftershocks) to determine where and when crimes will occur based on data sets of past crimes. In Santa Cruz, California, one of the pilot cities to first use



PredPol, the company used eleven years of local crime data to make predictions. In police departments that use PredPol, officers are given printouts of jurisdiction maps that are covered with red square boxes that indicate where crime is supposed to occur throughout the day. Officers are supposed to periodically patrol the boxes marked on the map in the hopes of either catching criminals or deterring potential criminals from committing crimes. The box is a kind of *temporary crime zone*: a geospatial area generated by mathematical models that are unknown to average police officers who are not privy to the algorithms, though they may have access to the data that is used to make the predictions.

What is the attitude or mentality of the officers who are patrolling one of the boxes? When they enter one of the boxes, do they expect to stumble upon a crime taking place? How might the expectation of finding crime influence what the officers actually find? Will people who pass through these temporary crime zones while they are being patrolled by officers automatically be perceived as suspicious? Could merely passing through one of the red boxes constitute probable cause? Some of these questions have already been asked by critics of PredPol. As Nick O'Malley notes in an article on PredPol, "Civil rights groups are taking [this] concern seriously because designating an area a



crime hot spot can be used as a factor in formulating ‘reasonable suspicion’ for stopping a suspect.”¹⁸

When the Cleveland police officer Timothy Loehmann arrived on the scene on November 22, 2014, it took him less than two seconds to fatally shoot Tamir Rice, a twelve-year-old black boy who was playing with a toy gun. This raises the question—if law enforcement officers are already too trigger-happy, will the little red boxes that mark temporary crime zones reduce the reaction time of officers while they’re in the designated boxes? How does labeling a space as an area where crime will occur affect how police interact with those spaces? Although PredPol conceptualizes the terrain that is being policed as a field where natural events occur, the way that data is interpreted and visualized is not a neat reflection of empirical reality; rather, data visualization actively *constructs* our reality.

Furthermore, how might civilians experience passing through one of the boxes? If I were to one day find myself in an invisible red box with an officer, I might have an extra cause for fear, or at least I would be conscious of the fact that I might be perceived as suspicious. But given that I am excluded from knowledge of where and when the red boxes will emerge, I cannot know when I might find myself in one of these temporary crime zones. Using methods that are inscrutable to citizens who do not have access to law enforcement



knowledge and infrastructure, PredPol is remaking and rearranging the space through which we move. That is the nature of algorithmic policing; the phenomenological experience of policing is qualitatively different from “repressive” policing, which takes place on a terrain that is visible and uses methods that can be scrutinized and contested. Predictive policing may induce a sense of being watched at all times by an eye we cannot see. If Jeremy Bentham’s eighteenth-century design of the “panopticon” is the architectural embodiment of Michel Foucault’s conception of disciplinary power, then algorithmic policing represents the inscription of disciplinary power across the entire terrain that is being policed.



False Positives

Given the difficulty of measuring the efficacy of predictive policing methods, there is a risk of falsely associating “positive” law enforcement outcomes with the use of predictive policing software such as PredPol. The literature on PredPol is also fuzzy on the question of how to measure its success. When police officers are dispatched to the 500-by-500 foot square boxes marked in red on city maps, are they expected to catch criminals in the act of committing crimes, or are they supposed to deter crime with their presence? The former implies that an



increase in arrests in designated areas would be a benchmark of success, while the latter implies that a decrease in crime is proof of the software's efficacy. However, both outcomes have been used to validate the success of PredPol. A news clip from its official YouTube account narrates the story of how the Norcross Police Department (Georgia) caught two burglars in the act of breaking into a house. Similarly, an article about PredPol published on Officer.com opens with the following anecdote: "Recently a Santa Cruz, Calif. police officer noticed a suspicious subject lurking around parked cars. When the officer attempted to make contact, the subject ran. The officer gave chase; when he caught the subject he learned he was a wanted parolee. Because there was an outstanding warrant for his arrest, the subject was taken to jail."¹⁹

Much of the literature PredPol uses for marketing offers similarly mystical accounts of the software's clairvoyant capacity to predict crime, and these are substantiated by anecdotes about officers stumbling upon criminals in the act of committing these crimes. However, PredPol consistently claims that its efficacy can be measured by a decrease in crime. Yet across the country, crime rates have been plummeting since the mid-1990s. In some cases, the company tries to take credit for crime reduction by implying that there is a causal relationship between the use of PredPol and a decrease in crime



rates, sometimes without explicitly making the claim. In an article linked on PredPol's website, the author notes, "When Santa Cruz implemented the predictive policing software in 2011, the city of nearly 60,000 was on pace to hit a record number of burglaries. But by July burglaries were down 27 percent when compared with July 2010."²⁰ Yet crime rates fluctuate from year to year, and it is impossible to parse which factors can be credited with reducing crime. Though the article does not explicitly attribute the crime reduction to PredPol, it implicitly links the use of PredPol to the 27 percent burglary reduction by juxtaposing the two separate occurrences—the adoption of PredPol and the decrease in burglaries—so as to construct a presumed causal relation. The article goes on to use explanations made by Zach Friend (about why and how PredPol works) to validate its efficacy. Friend is described as "a crime analyst with the Santa Cruz PD"; however, Friend actually left the Santa Cruz Police Department to become one of the main lobbyists for PredPol soon after the company was founded.

By scrutinizing the PR circuits that link the UCLA researchers to the police, and link Silicon Valley investors to the media, one realizes that essentially all claims about the efficacy of PredPol loop back to the company itself. Though PredPol's website advertises "scientifically proven field



results,” no disinterested third party has ever substantiated the company’s claims. What’s even more troubling is that PredPol offered 50 percent discounts on the software to police departments that agreed to participate as “showcase cities” in PredPol’s pilot program. The program required collaboration with the company for three years and required police departments to provide testimonials that could be used to market the software. For instance, *SF Weekly* notes that:



the city of Alhambra, just northeast of Los Angeles, purchased PredPol’s software in 2012 for \$27,500. The contract between Alhambra and PredPol includes numerous obligations requiring Alhambra to carry out marketing and promotion on PredPol’s behalf. Alhambra’s police and public officials must “provide testimonials, as requested by PredPol,” and “provide referrals and facilitate introductions to other agencies who can utilize the PredPol tool.”²¹



In “The Difference Prevention Makes: Regulating Preventive Justice,” David Cole describes five major risks that come with the adoption of the “paradigm of prevention” in law enforcement. He notes that “it is not just that we cannot know the efficacy of prevention; our assessments are likely to be systematically skewed.”²² Others have raised



similar concerns with PredPol. According to O'Malley, "The American Criminal Law Review has raised concerns the program could warp crime statistics, either by increasing the arrest rate in the boxes through extra policing or falsely reducing it through diffusion."²³

The Politics of Crime Data



Crime has never been a neutral category. What counts as crime, who gets labeled criminal, and which areas are policed have historically been racialized. Brantingham, the anthropologist who helped create PredPol, noted, "The focus on time and location data—rather than the personal demographics of criminals—potentially reduces any biases officers might have with regard to suspects' race or socioeconomic status." Though it is true that PredPol is a spatialized form of predictive policing that does not target individuals or generate heat lists, spatial algorithmic policing, even when it does not use race to make predictions, can facilitate racial profiling by calculating proxies for race, such as neighborhood and location. Furthermore, predictive models are only as good as the datasets they use to make predictions, so it is important to interrogate *who* collects data and *how* it is collected. Although data has been conceptualized as neutral bits of information about our





world and our behaviors, in the domain of criminal justice, it is a reflection of who has been targeted for surveillance and policing. If someone commits a crime in an area that is not heavily policed—such as on Wall Street or in the white suburbs—it will fail to generate any data. PredPol’s reliance on the dirty data collected by the police may create a feedback loop that leads to the ossification of racialized police practices. Furthermore, when applied to predictive policing, the idea that “more data is better,” in that it would improve accuracy and efficiency, justifies dragnet surveillance and the expansion of policing and carceral operations that generate data.



Though PredPol presents itself as race-neutral, its treatment of crime as an objective force that operates according to laws that govern natural phenomena, such as earthquake aftershocks—and not as a socially constructed category that has meaning only in a specific social context—ignores the a priori racialization of crime, and specifically the association of crime with blackness. Historian Khalil Gibran Muhammad’s *The Condemnation of Blackness: Race, Crime and the Making of Modern America* traces how “[a]t the dawn of the twentieth century, in a rapidly industrializing, urbanizing, and demographically shifting America, blackness was refashioned through crime statistics. It became a more stabilizing racial category in opposition to



whiteness through racial criminalization.”²⁴ Muhammad describes how data was used primarily by social scientists in the North to make the conflation of blackness and criminality appear objective and empirically sound, thus justifying a number of antiblack social practices such as segregation, racial violence, and penal confinement. The consolidation of this “scientific” notion of black criminality also enabled formerly criminalized immigrant populations—such as the Polish, Irish, and Italians—to be assimilated into the category of whiteness. As black Americans were pathologized by statistical discourse, the public became increasingly sympathetic to the problems of European ethnic groups, and white ethnic participation in criminal activities was attributed to structural inequalities and poverty, as opposed to personal shortcomings or innate inferiority. According to Muhammad, the 1890 census laid much of the groundwork for this ideology. He describes how statistics about higher rates of imprisonment among black Americans, particularly in northern penitentiaries, were “analyzed and interpreted as definitive proof of blacks’ true criminal nature.”²⁵ Thus, biological and cultural racism was eventually supplanted by statistical racism.

While the methods developed by PredPol themselves are not explicitly racialized, they are implicitly racialized insofar as geography is a proxy for race.



Furthermore, given that crime has historically been racialized, taking crime for granted as a neutral—or rather, *natural*—category around which to organize predictive policing practices is likely to reproduce racist patterns of policing. As PredPol relies on data about where previous crimes have occurred, and as police are more likely to police neighborhoods that are primarily populated by people of color (as well as target people of color for searches and arrests), then the data itself that PredPol relies on is systematically skewed. By presenting its methods as objective and racially neutral, PredPol veils how the data and the categories it relies on are already shaped by structural racism.



Conclusion



The story of policing in the twenty-first century cannot be reduced to the stereotypical image of bellicose, meathead officers looking for opportunities to catch bad guys and to flaunt their institutional power. As Donnie Fowler, the PredPol director of business development, was quoted saying in the *Silicon Valley Business Journal*, twenty-first-century policing could more accurately be described as “a story about nerds and cops.”²⁶ However, more than a story of an unlikely marriage between data-crunching professors and crime-fighting officers, the story of algorithmic policing, and PredPol in



particular, is also a story of intimate collaboration between domestic law enforcement, the university, the Department of Defense, Silicon Valley, and the media. It is a story of a form of techno-governance that operates at the intersection between knowledge and power. Yet the numerical and data-driven approach embodied by PredPol has been taken up in a number of domains. In both finance and policing, there has been a turn toward technical solutions to the problem of uncertainty, solutions that attempt to manage risk using complex and opaque mathematical models. Yet, although the language of risk has replaced the language of race, both algorithmic policing and risk-adjusted finance merely code racial inequality as risk. It is important that we pay attention to this paradigm shift, as once the “digital carceral infrastructure” is built up, it will be nearly impossible to undo, and the automated carceral surveillance state will spread out across the terrain, making greater and greater intrusions into our everyday lives.²⁷ Not only will the “smart” state have more granular knowledge of our movements and activities, but as the carceral state becomes more automated, it will increase its capacity to process ever-greater numbers of people, even when budgets remain stagnant or are cut.

Though it is necessary to acknowledge the invisible, algorithmic (or “cybernetic”) underside



of policing, it is important to recognize that algorithmic policing has not supplanted repressive policing, but is its corollary. “Soft control” has not replaced hard forms of control. Police have become more militarized than ever as a result of the \$34 billion in federal grants that have been given to domestic police departments by the Department of Homeland Security in the wake of 9/11. While repressive policing attempts to respond to events that have already occurred, algorithmic policing attempts to maintain law and order by actively preventing crime. Yet is it possible that the latter actually creates a situation that leads to the multiplication of threats rather than the achievement of safety? As predictive policing practices are taken up by local police departments across the country, perhaps we might consider the extent to which, as Tiqqun writes, “the control society is a paranoid society.”²⁸

